



ownership was once foreign to the Maasai, yet they now find themselves struggling to gain access to their traditional grazing lands. This is due to the tourist industry, catering to the growing Western appetite for safaris.

Many Maasai have responded to this by opening their villages to tourists. Selling craftwork and performing for tourists brings in money, but some Maasai feel it is undignified to sell their culture in this way.



CATTLE BLOOD

High in protein, cattle blood is given to the sick, to women after childbirth, and to men recovering from circumcision. To extract the blood, a vein is opened up in the animal's neck. It is sealed after the blood has been extracted, doing no permanent damage to the animal.



Women and girls

Maasai women build and maintain the home, collect water and firewood, look after children and animals, and do skilled beadwork. More recently, some women have begun growing and selling vegetables. Maasai girls undergo initiation at puberty and are married soon after, often to much older men who have completed their time as *moran*.



BEAUTIFUL BEADWORK

Women buy bright plastic beads from non-Maasai and use them to make distinctive jewelry. Rules dictate which colors may be used and in what combinations. The women in the picture are in a tourist *manyatta* (village) on the edge of the Maasai Mara game reserve, where tourists can watch them as they work.

